

MORNING REFLECTIONS - GUIDING STUDENTS

Description of Morning Reflection

Morning reflections will take place immediately following morning services. Students will gather with their group leaders where leaders will encourage them to spend time praying and reflecting on what they learned during the message, what God has been showing them through camp, and what God is leading them into.

Goal of Morning Reflection

Make prayer approachable to students.

Create a discipline within camp that is transferable when students go home.

Center students on the focus of camp - the person of Jesus.

Posture students' hearts for the upcoming breakout session.

How to Prepare Students for Morning Reflection

"Clarify the confusing." Oftentimes students avoid what is confusing. Prayer can seem daunting, that's why we've partnered it with the word "reflection" for each morning. Share with them that prayer is a time to reflect on and grow their relationship with God.

"Prioritize palatable." Teach the students that prayer is tangible. This looks like a conversation. Encourage them to talk to God as though He's a friend right next to them, listening to every word - because He is. Clarify that while they're praying, they may not hear an audible voice - but they may hear something on the inside of them - a thought that isn't from them. A nudge or notion that isn't from them. Also share that sometimes you hear something, sometimes you don't - but this time always strengthens your relationship with Jesus.

"Offer an outline." Providing students with a general outline for how they can pray/reflect will show what this can look like, and how their time can be spent.

Outline - ACTS

A good alliteration for prayer time is ACTS. Encourage students to spend about two to three minutes on each letter of ACTS, with one to two minutes of listening in between each letter. See below:

Adoration. Begin by praising God. Express your thoughts about Him, His character, His power, His glory, etc.

Sit quietly, listening.

Confession. Share with God where you've fallen short, or missed the mark. Ask him to forgive you, and He will.

Sit quietly, listening.

Thanksgiving. Express your gratitude towards God for everything He's has given you, blessings, gifts, family, friends, food, clothes, etc. Every good gift is from God.

Sit quietly, listening.

Supplication. Present your requests to God. This is both requests for yourself, and for others.

Sit quietly, listening.